



PHISHING AWARENESS TRAINING

Prepared By

Ananya Achalendran

CodeAlpha Cyber Security Internship

What is Phishing?



Phishing is a type of cyberattack where attackers impersonate trusted individuals or organizations to trick users into revealing confidential information such as usernames, passwords, banking details, or personal information.

Objectives of Phishing



Steal login credentials



Obtain financial information



Install malware on victim devices



Commit identity theft



Gain unauthorized access to systems

Common Types of Phishing Attacks



Email Phishing

Fraudulent emails sent to many users pretending to be from trusted organizations.



Spear Phishing

Highly targeted phishing attacks aimed at a specific person or organization.



Whaling

Targets executives or senior management using personalized attacks.



Smishing

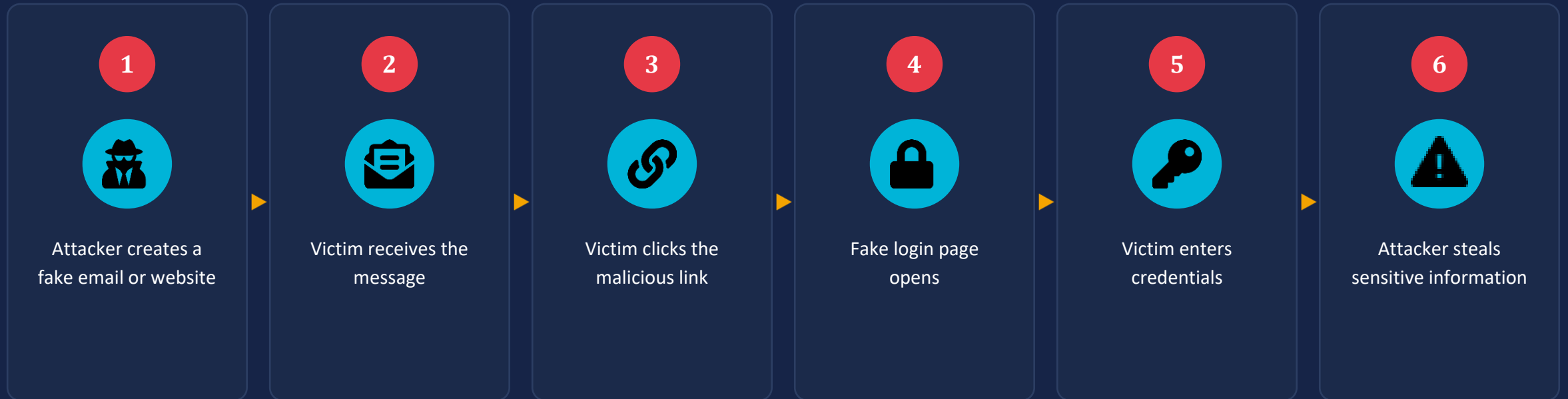
Phishing attacks delivered through SMS or text messages.



Vishing

Phishing attacks carried out through voice calls.

How a Phishing Attack Unfolds



Result

The attacker gains unauthorized access to the victim's accounts or personal information.

How to Identify a Phishing Email



Unknown or suspicious sender



Generic greetings (e.g., “Dear Customer”)



Urgent or threatening language



Poor grammar and spelling mistakes



Suspicious links or attachments



Requests for passwords or banking details



Offers that seem too good to be true



When in doubt, verify — don't click.

Recognizing Fake Websites



Legitimate Website

`https://www.paypal.com`



Fake Website

`https://www.paypaI.com`

Notice the capital "I" replacing the lowercase "l".

Always Check



Website URL



HTTPS connection



Domain spelling



Security certificate

How Attackers Manipulate Victims



Fear

"Your account will be suspended."



Urgency

"Verify your account within 24 hours."



Curiosity

"You have received a new document."



Authority

Pretending to be a bank, company, or government official.



Rewards

"You have won a prize."

How to Protect Yourself



Verify the sender before responding.



Check URLs carefully before clicking.



Never share passwords or OTPs.



Enable Multi-Factor Authentication (MFA).



Keep your software updated.



Use antivirus and email filtering tools.



Report suspicious emails immediately.

Real-World Example

Google Docs Phishing Attack (2017)



What Happened?

Attackers sent fake Google Docs invitations that appeared to come from trusted contacts.



Impact

- Thousands of users were affected.
- Victims unknowingly granted access to malicious applications.



Lesson Learned

Always verify links and application permissions before granting access.

Test Your Knowledge

1

What is phishing?

A A programming language

B A cyberattack that tricks users into revealing sensitive information

C A firewall

D A network protocol

Answer: B

2

Which of the following is a warning sign of phishing?

A Secure HTTPS website

B Personalized communication from a trusted source

C Urgent request for passwords

D Software updates from official websites

Answer: C

3

What should you do before clicking a link?

A Click immediately

B Ignore the sender

C Verify the URL and sender

D Share it with friends

Answer: C

Conclusion

Phishing remains one of the most common cyber threats, but awareness is the strongest defense.



Stay alert to suspicious emails and websites.



Use Multi-Factor Authentication.



Verify links before clicking.



Report phishing attempts promptly.



Protect your credentials.

Thank You